Draft for discussion

Northline Rail Programme: October 2026 status report

Built from the project's own schedule, risk register, RAID log and benefits register

Northline Transport Authority | 4 November 2026 | Programme Management Office

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Handover has slipped three weeks since September, and two risks have escalated to red

Area	Status	Trend	Summary
Schedule	Red	▼	Handover forecast moved **21 days** since September, to **15 May 2027**. Main civils finished 30 Oct, six weeks late.
Risk	Red	▼	R07 (signalling software) rose from 12 to 20 and R12 (Christmas possessions) from 9 to 16. R21 fell from 9 to 6.
Benefits	Amber	▶	No benefits are realised before handover; both remain on track to be measured from May 2027.

On track · At risk, recoverable · Off track, decision needed · ▼ Worse · ▶ Unchanged · ▲ Better

Look-ahead: key milestones in the next 90 days

Milestone	Baseline	Forecast	Variance	Status
Signalling software drop 4 accepted	30 Oct	8 Nov	+9 days	Amber
Main civils complete	31 Oct	12 Nov	**+12 days**	Red
Test windows confirmed by operator	1 Nov	14 Nov	**+13 days**	Red
Station 3 fit-out complete	12 Dec	19 Dec	+7 days	Amber

Decisions needed

1. **Approve the £14m contingency drawdown**
   Owner: SRO **Due:** 14 Nov
2. **Sponsor sign-off for contingency below the 5% floor**
   Owner: Sponsor **Due:** 21 Nov

Approving the £14m drawdown by 14 November protects the 15 May handover

1. RAG from forecast finish against plan: on plan green, up to 10 working days amber, more red.
Source: schedule.xer (P6, data date 31 Oct 2026); risk-register.xlsx; raid.csv; benefits.csv; SteerCo transcript 28 Oct. Fictional example.

Four milestones moved since September; handover now depends on the operator's test windows

Milestone movement since the September report

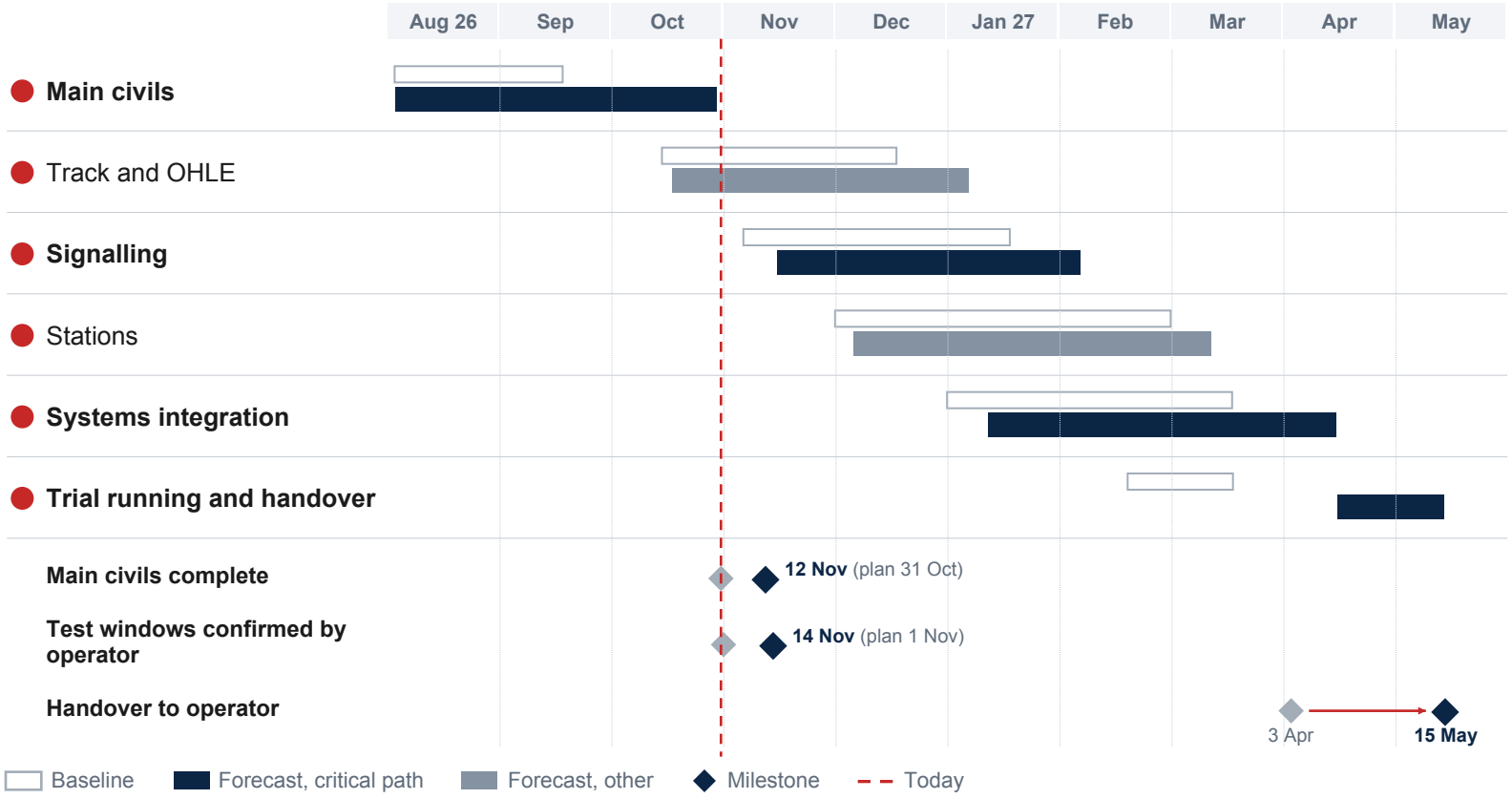
Milestone	September forecast	October forecast	Moved
Main civils complete	20 Oct 2026	12 Nov 2026	+23 days
Signalling software drop 4 accepted	1 Nov 2026	8 Nov 2026	+7 days
Test windows confirmed by operator	5 Nov 2026	14 Nov 2026	+9 days
Handover to operator	24 Apr 2027	15 May 2027	**+21 days**

1. Compares the October schedule (data date 31 Oct) with the September snapshot (data date 30 Sep).
Source: schedule.xer (P6, data date 31 Oct 2026); risk-register.xlsx; raid.csv; benefits.csv; SteerCo transcript 28 Oct. Fictional example.

Systems integration and trial running now drive the handover date

Schedule, baseline vs current forecast

NORTHLINE, data date 31 Oct



What the schedule shows

1. Every workstream is forecast to finish after plan; the critical path runs through signalling and systems integration.
2. Handover is forecast for **15 May 2027**, six weeks after the planned 3 April.

Schedule quality

- 4 of 11 activities lack a predecessor or successor; fix before the next risk analysis
- No negative float

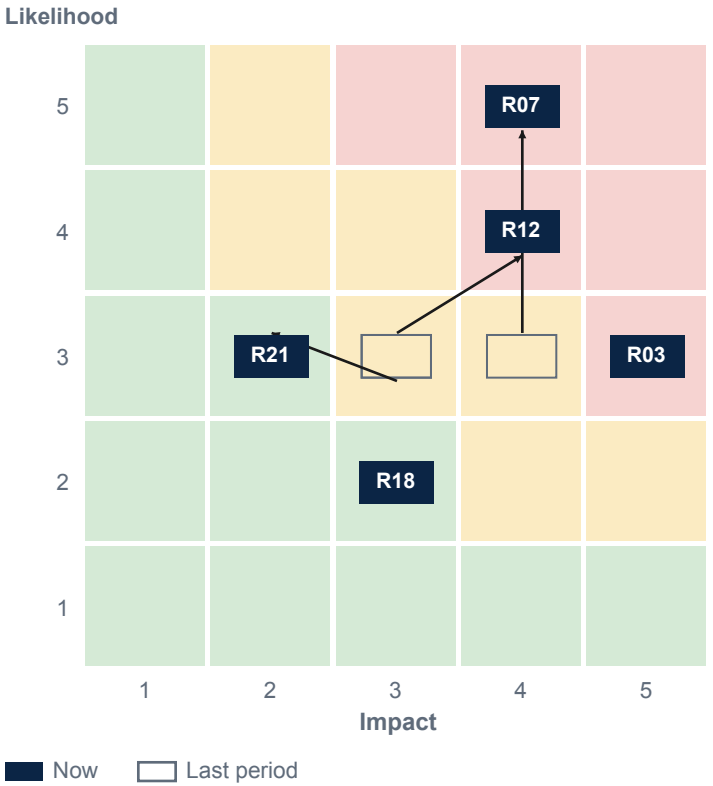
1. Planned dates are the P6 target dates. RAG from forecast finish against plan.

Source: schedule.xer (P6, data date 31 Oct 2026); risk-register.xlsx; raid.csv; benefits.csv; SteerCo transcript 28 Oct. Fictional example.

Two risks moved into the red zone this month, and neither has a funded mitigation

Top risks, current position

Likelihood x impact



ID	Risk	Owner	Score		Mitigation and status
R07	Signalling software maturity: supplier missed drops 3 and 4	S. Novak	**12 → 20**	▲	Recovery plan due 8 Nov; independent code review proposed (unfunded)
R12	Christmas possessions: 3 of 5 weekends unconfirmed	Interface lead	**9 → 16**	▲	Escalated to Network Rail route director; decision 21 Nov
R03	Utilities diversion claims from main contractor	R. Dube	**15 → 15**	▶	£6-9m exposure; valuation agreed, settlement talks under way
R18	Driver training capacity for trial running	K. Ahmed	**6 → 6**	▶	Second simulator booked from January
R21	Late design changes at Station 3	A. Silva	**9 → 6**	▼	Design freeze agreed 15 Oct

▲ Score rising ▶ Unchanged ▼ Score falling

1. Text ratings in the register mapped to 1-5 (very low to very high). Arrows show movement since the September register.
Source: schedule.xer (P6, data date 31 Oct 2026); risk-register.xlsx; raid.csv; benefits.csv; SteerCo transcript 28 Oct. Fictional example.

Open RAID items needing attention before the next report

Type	ID	Description	Owner	Due	RAG	Status and next action
Risk	R07	Signalling software maturity	S. Novak	2026-11-08	●	Recovery plan due
Issue	I04	Test windows not confirmed by operator	L. Chen	2026-11-14	●	SteerCo decision
Assumption	A02	Possessions available at Easter 2027	Interface lead	2027-01-31	●	Confirm with Network Rail
Dependency	D01	Operator driver training complete	K. Ahmed	2027-03-31	●	On plan

● On track ● At risk ● Off track or overdue

Source: schedule.xer (P6, data date 31 Oct 2026); risk-register.xlsx; raid.csv; benefits.csv; SteerCo transcript 28 Oct. Fictional example.

Both benefits are measured from handover, so neither has started to be realised

Benefit	Owner	Baseline	Target	Actual	Progress to target	Status	Due
Journey time saving (minutes)	Sponsor	0 min	6 min	0 min	**0%**	At risk	May 27
Peak capacity (trains per hour)	Operator	12 tph	18 tph	12 tph	**0%**	At risk	May 27

Achieved · Remaining to target · On track · At risk · Off track

Source: schedule.xer (P6, data date 31 Oct 2026); risk-register.xlsx; raid.csv; benefits.csv; SteerCo transcript 28 Oct. Fictional example.